

The Storyteller's Role

Whether the troupe makes characters together (which is recommended), or players make characters on their own, it's usually a good idea for the Storyteller to be there, whether digitally or in person. This is particularly true for new players who have never made a **Changeling** character before, of course, but is still valuable even for veteran players. Players often have questions about the setting that only the Storyteller can answer, such as whether particular Traits are likely to be useful or if certain other Traits are restricted, not to mention narrative questions such as who the local nobles are or whether it is acceptable to have a family friend who knows about the character's true nature.

Storytellers, for your part, don't feel as though you have to answer all of these questions on your own! It's perfectly acceptable to turn questions back on the player or field them to the group as a whole if you don't have an answer. For example, if a player asks who the local nobles are, you could always ask the group, "Who do you guys think would be in charge around here? What are they like?" Even if you decide to go in a slightly different direction than the players suggest, the brainstorming can be a real help during the character creation process.

It's also a good idea to refrain from trying to teach a player all of the rules in detail as they go through character creation. While it's born of good intentions, it often just winds up bogging down the process and making things more complicated. Answer simple questions to avoid confusion, but save detailed overall rules and systems explanations for later, when they can be addressed in one fell swoop. If players decide they don't want certain Traits after learning more about how they work, it's acceptable to swap them out provided the Storyteller approves.

Setting Started

As you prepare to design your character, there are a few solid guidelines to keep in mind.

- ⑤ Your character is a changeling, a fae soul housed in a human body who must balance living in the world of mortals with existing in the enchanted world of the Kithain. It's okay to play a character who doesn't know much about changeling society or the enchanted world; that's actually how many characters begin! Don't worry about not knowing enough "lore" about the setting, as it can be a lot of fun for both player and character to learn about this new world simultaneously.
- ⑤ That said, it's still advisable for new players to read Chapter One: The Dreaming, Chapter Two: Seemings, Kiths & Houses, and Chapter Three: Character Creation & Traits in order to learn some of the basics of the game and its setting.

Not only is it useful information to know, it can also ensure that players don't create characters with false assumptions about the setting.

- ⑤ **Changeling** characters can be of any age, race, culture, and gender identity.
- ⑤ All characters are unique. While certain norms and even stereotypes exist as part of the setting, that doesn't mean your character must conform to them. So long as the Storyteller feels a departure from the norm is warranted by your character's backstory, he may allow it. The Storyteller has the final word on what is permitted in his chronicle, but as a rule of thumb, the more your justification is based on a good narrative reason as opposed to a purely mechanical benefit, the more likely it is that the Storyteller will grant an exception.
- ⑤ **Changeling** is a game, and as such, it has rules in order to prevent confusion and adjudicate the success or failure of certain actions in the narrative. As part of character creation, you will be assigning numerical values to different Traits to represent your character's prowess and capabilities. You may find that you are not able to have every Trait that you want right away. That's fine! Characters are intended to grow and change as the game goes on, and having goals to aspire to can make for excellent motivation. The method for assigning values and tracking Traits will be explained throughout this chapter.

Step One: Character Concept

The very first step of character creation is coming up with an idea of the role you wish to portray, the persona you will adopt as the story unfolds. At this point it's best to pick a few central ideas you like but to keep the rest fluid, as you may find elements changing while the process goes on. Don't fret if you change your mind or double back, as nothing is set in stone until character creation is over, and even then many Storytellers allow players to tweak their characters for the first session or two if certain choices don't turn out to be what they imagined.

Examples:

- ⑤ A brilliant orphaned immigrant who speaks out against the injustices of Kithain society, and views his revolutionary motley as the family he never had.
- ⑤ A priest whose sluagh nature leads him to try to reconcile the lingering departed with their loved ones, and help conclude their unfinished business.
- ⑤ A photojournalist whose award-winning work has taken her all around the globe, but who is secretly worried that she's missing out on too much with all her traveling.
- ⑤ A struggling college student trying to balance his studies with a chaotic family life and his responsibilities as the local noble's new chancellor.
- ⑤ A classically-trained artist who opens a tattoo parlor in order to pursue her new passion, to the dismay of her traditional parents and disapproving fiancée.